Cem (Jack) Guler

Applied-AI Innovation Leader | Media & Public-Interest Broadcasting | AI Literacy & Responsible Adoption

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Profile

Journalist turned AI builder with 17 years carrying stories to the public across every new medium: live broadcast news, documentary, XR and now generative AI, always with a human answerable for the result. Founder of GEN:A Labs, an applied-AI lab that moves every engagement from diagnostic to baseline, pilot and handover. Fluent in editorial standards and engineering pipelines alike, I connect content, operations and technology teams around responsible, measurable AI adoption. Author of *THE NEW CAVE* on human accountability after AI; speaker at The Walrus Talks on AI and Canadian culture.

Core Competencies

Innovation Pipeline & Operating Model
intake, assessment, KPIs and pipeline observability; AI trend scanning turned into capability recommendations

Cross-Functional Bridging & Governance
translating editorial and operational needs into AI projects; working with legal, security and governance on risk

Enablement, Playbooks & AI Literacy
responsible-AI playbooks, assessment frameworks, workshops and community programs for non-technical teams

Accelerator: Experiment → MVP → Rollout
stage gates with baselines and exit criteria; MVP incubation through operational rollout; shared tool and pilot registry

AI Platform Evaluation & Selection
hands-on assessment of frontier models and generative tools; aligning tool choices with business and creative backlogs

Thought Leadership
public speaking, published author and filmmaker; representing applied AI to cultural, media and public audiences

Experience

Founder · **GEN:A Labs**, Ottawa, ON — Jan 2026 – Present

Applied-AI innovation, technology and science lab: SME AI adoption, youth AI capability-building and applied delivery.

- Designed and run a staged operating model (**Workflow X-Ray diagnostic → pilot build → build-and-transfer**) in which every engagement starts from a written baseline metric and ends with a documented handover the client team owns.
- Productized three AI workflows (AI receptionist, document-to-record, automated follow-up), each validated in-house before client use.
- Prototype hands-on with AI app builders (Lovable) and coding agents (Claude Code, Codex); working MVPs include an investor narrative site, an interactive history platform for families and a tender-analysis tool.
- Lead youth AI capability-building and SME adoption work on one method: pick one workflow, write down today's number, change one thing, measure again, then write the playbook so the team can own it.

Founder & Product Lead · **Ottawa Civic Chronicle**, Ottawa, ON — May 2026 – Present

- Building, with AI (Lovable), a bilingual EN/FR citizen-journalism platform for Ottawa, now a prototype in development: neighbourhood-level reporting, live local alerts and reader-submitted stories that connect residents to city issues.
- Applying newsroom standards (verification, fact-checking, solutions journalism) to an AI-built civic product; "glocal to global": local problems paired with how they were solved elsewhere.

Co-Founder, Concept & Creative Direction · **Parallax XP**, Ottawa, ON — Nov 2025 – Present

- Conceived *The Expedition Within*, a 90-minute bilingual EN/FR immersive journey across six chambers and five acts, opening in Ottawa in 2027; spatial and interior design near complete; seed round in progress.

Creative Director & Producer · **Everstar XR Company**, New York (remote) — Nov 2023 – Jan 2026

- Launched a three-episode **AI-native animated series**: storyboards, environments, video generation and original music produced end-to-end through AI pipelines, with human creative direction throughout.
- Selected and integrated generative image, video and music tools into a repeatable pipeline, from experiment to release.
- Directed and produced Unreal Engine animated films built as XR experiences, released in VR and 3D versions.

Marketing Team Lead · **MetaCampus**, London (remote) May 2023 – Oct 2023

- Directed the integration of generative AI tools into marketing campaigns and UX workflows, an early team-level adoption effort.
- Led brand campaigns with data-driven iteration against KPIs; ran UI/UX reviews and user research; mentored junior staff.

Founder & Director · **Silvermoon Pictures**, Ottawa, ON Mar 2018 – Present

- Festival-selected documentaries (*THE TERRIBLE*); commercial films for fashion, tech and finance clients; AI video and imagery.
- Directing a 6th-century historical animated feature in Unreal Engine with MetaHuman, Character Creator 4 and iClone.

Broadcast & Journalism Roles · **TRT World / TRT 2**, Istanbul, Türkiye Oct 2008 – Jun 2015

> **Broadcast Producer/Director, TRT World** Jan 2013 – Jun 2015
> Directed TV shows for an international news channel; owned production schedules, budgets, and quality and editorial-standards compliance. Project Coordinator, MIPTV/MIPDOC Cannes 2013.
>
> **Multimedia Journalist, TRT World** Jan 2011 – Mar 2013
> Multi-platform reporting. Nominated, Best Photograph, Courage in Journalism Awards (Journalists Association).
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> **Video Journalist, TRT 2** Oct 2008 – Mar 2011
> Live breaking news; sourcing and verification; shooting and editing for air.

Additional Experience

- **Co-Founder, Taksim Sweets & Bakes**, Ottawa (Jan 2025 – Present): café and community art-and-tech space: VR nights, tech-and-art roundtables for journalists and creatives.
- **UX Designer (Co-op), Bombardier**, Toronto (remote) (Nov 2018 – Apr 2019): user research, testing, prototyping, accessibility.
- **Creative Director, Pollux Films**, Istanbul (Jul 2015 – Jun 2016): investigative and human-interest multimedia stories (video, audio, graphics).

Thought Leadership & Publications

- **Speaker, The Walrus Talks Cultural Futures**, Ottawa, Feb 20, 2024: "The Journalist's New Frontier: Harnessing Tech to Tell Tomorrow's Stories," on how AI is affecting Canadian arts and culture (billed as AI Educator, Filmmaker, Former Journalist).
- **Author, *THE NEW CAVE: Reality, Responsibility & the Human After AI***: what must remain human (judgment, expertise and accountability) as AI grows capable, across classrooms, medicine, courts and work.
- **Documentary, *THE TERRIBLE***: the Ottoman wrestler Yusuf Ismail, a legend in the 1890s West. Main Competition, Vox Popular Media Arts Festival; narrated by Adrian Harewood; screened in the US, Germany, Toronto and Ottawa. Companion book forthcoming, drawn from ~2.5 years of research across 10,000+ archival sources.
- **Author, *BEFORE THE HAND*** (forthcoming book).
- **Creator & Host, *Radio Days***: radio program on the untold, behind-the-scenes stories of radio people and the medium's history.

AI & Creative Toolkit

Claude & Claude Code · OpenAI Codex & ChatGPT · Google Gemini (Nano Banana, Veo) · AI music generation · Unreal Engine, MetaHuman, Character Creator 4, iClone · Adobe Creative Suite · UX research & prototyping

Education

Postgraduate Certificate, User Experience (UX) Design, Humber College 2018 – 2019
Communication & Media Studies, Humber College 2017 – 2018
Master's, Fine/Studio Arts, Istanbul Arel University 2014 – 2017
Journalism, Faculty of Communication Sciences, Anadolu University 2002 – 2008

Languages

Turkish (native) · English (professional)